Grade 11 English

Solved Exercises

Balochistan Textbook Board (BTBB)

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Unit 1: Of Studies (Francis Bacon)

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (A)

Q1. Identify the three main purposes of studies according to Bacon.

Ans. According to Bacon, studies serve three main purposes: for delight, for ornament, and for ability. Delight gives private pleasure in solitude, ornament adds grace to discourse, and ability helps in judgement and the handling of business.

Q2. 'Reading maketh a full man; conference a ready man; and writing an exact man.' Explain.

Ans. Reading fills the mind with knowledge, so it makes a man 'full'. Discussion or conference makes him quick and ready in reply. Writing forces him to be precise and accurate, so it makes him 'exact'.

Q3. According to Bacon some books are to be 'tasted', others 'swallowed', and some few 'chewed and digested'. What does he mean?

Ans. Bacon means that all books do not deserve equal attention. Some books need only be sampled in parts, others read fully but without deep study, while a few great books must be read slowly, carefully and with full attention until their meaning is absorbed.

Q4. Describe Bacon's view on using studies for ornament and judgement.

Ans. Bacon says studies give ornament to speech, but he warns

against using them only for show or display. Their true use is for judgement and ability: they should guide decisions and conduct, not merely decorate conversation or win arguments.

Q5. How does Bacon suggest that different subjects can cure specific deficiencies?

Ans. Bacon compares studies to medicine for the mind. Histories make men wise, poets witty, mathematics subtle, natural philosophy deep, moral philosophy grave, and logic and rhetoric able to contend. Just as exercise cures a bodily defect, a suitable study can correct a mental weakness.

Q6. How does Bacon describe the relationship between studies and experience?

Ans. Bacon says studies perfect nature, and nature itself is perfected by experience. Studies give general rules, but experience adds practical wisdom. A man who relies only on books is unfit for practical life, while experience without study remains limited.

Q7. Does Bacon believe that all studies are equally useful? Explain with examples.

Ans. No, Bacon does not believe all studies are equally useful. He advises that some books are only to be tasted, others swallowed, and only a few chewed and digested. For example, histories are valuable for wisdom, but light reading cannot give the depth that serious study of philosophy or mathematics gives.

Q8. Justify if practical experience and discussion play a role in

making

use of one's studies, according to Bacon.

Ans. Yes, both play an important role. Bacon says conference makes a ready man, because discussion tests and sharpens what is read. Experience turns book knowledge into sound judgement, since teaches rules while life teaches how and when to apply them.

Q9. Describe the warning given by Bacon about studying too much or misusing studies.

Ans. Bacon warns that spending too much time on studies is sloth, using them only for ornament is affectation, and judging everything by bookish rules is the humour of a scholar. Studies should also not be used for contradiction, for believing everything, or for mere talk and show.

Q10. Write briefly the philosophy in Bacon's essay 'Of Studies', particularly his advice on reading.

Ans. Bacon's philosophy is that studies must be used wisely and practically, balanced with experience and discussion. His advice on reading is to read not to contradict or to believe blindly, but to weigh and consider; to read with purpose, choosing the depth of reading according to the worth of the book.

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (B) MCQs

1. Studies serve for delight, for ornament, and for:

- wisdom
- ✓ ability
- show
- ease

2. Bacon says, 'reading maketh a full':

- book
- memory
- scholar
- ✓ man

3. Writing maketh an exact:

- poet
- Philosopher
- ✓ man
- thinker

4. Histories make men:

- ✓ wise
- brave
- honest
- Philosophical

5. Studies should not be used for:

- delight
- ornament
- ✓ disputation
- ability

6. According to Bacon, studies perfect:

- ✓ nature
- speech

memory

judgement

Vocabulary and Grammar - Figurative Language and Sentences

Figurative use: 'Pen is mightier than sword' means writing and ideas are more powerful than weapons; 'He is an institute in himself' means he himself embodies knowledge and learning. Literal use: 'She is writing with a blue pen' and 'The institute will be closed tomorrow' use pen and institute in their ordinary, physical sense.

Four kinds of sentences: Declarative (gives information, ends with a full stop), Imperative (gives a command or request), Interrogative (asks a question, ends with a question mark), and Exclamatory (expresses strong feeling, ends with an exclamation mark).

Writing Task - Model Answer

Model paragraph on 'Illiteracy': Illiteracy keeps people trapped in poverty because they cannot read instructions, sign documents, or learn new skills. Education is like a lantern in darkness: it lights the path of a poor child, awakens silent dreams, and turns forgotten villages into thriving centres of hope. When a child learns to read, the whole family gains confidence, better health, and better work, so schooling is the surest way to end poverty.

Unit 2: Are Doctors Men of Science? (George Bernard Shaw)

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (A)

Q1. Explain the reason of Shaw's question whether doctors are 'Men of science'.

Ans. Shaw asks this question because he doubts whether doctors practise true science. He observes that many doctors rely on habit, tradition and guesswork rather than on careful experiment and proof, so he questions whether their work deserves the name of science.

Q2. How does Shaw portray the medical profession in this essay?

Ans. Shaw portrays doctors as powerful but not always scientific. He shows them as men who enjoy public trust and high fees, yet often follow fashion in treatment, protect their own interests, and resist ideas that threaten their authority.

Q3. Describe the way Shaw is likely to respond to a modern-day situation where a doctor chooses patients based on social status or wealth.

Ans. Shaw would strongly condemn such a doctor. He would say the doctor is serving money and status instead of science and humanity, and that a profession which sells care to the rich while neglecting the poor has lost its moral and scientific claim.

Q4. Imagine you are a medical student. How would reading this essay influence your approach to medical ethics?

Ans. As a medical student, this essay would teach me to value honesty, evidence and patient welfare above profit and prestige. I would question claims, demand proof for treatments, and treat rich and poor patients with equal care and respect.

Q5. Highlight the way Shaw uses satire to criticize the medical profession.

Ans. Shaw uses sharp wit and irony to expose doctors' pretensions. He praises them in a way that actually reveals their ignorance, compares their fashions to superstition, and makes their love of fees and status look foolish, so the reader laughs while seeing the serious fault.

Q6. Identify the significance of the title 'Are Doctors Men of Science'.

Ans. The title is a direct challenge. It asks the reader to test doctors against the standard of real science: observation, experiment and proof. Its significance is that it refuses to accept a title on trust and demands evidence before honouring any profession.

Q7. Do you agree with Shaw's view that doctors often lack true scientific objectivity? Why or why not?

Ans. I partly agree with Shaw. In his time many treatments rested on custom rather than proof, and even today commercial pressure can bias practice. However, modern medicine is far more evidence-based than in Shaw's day, so his criticism is a warning to stay scientific, not a fair judgement of all doctors.

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (B) MCQs

1. 'Are Doctors Men of Science' is written by:

- Charles Dickens
- Oscar Wilde
- ✓ George Bernard Shaw
- T.S. Eliot

2. This essay is taken from the preface of the play:

- Pygmalion
- Major Barbara
- Heartbreak House
- ✓ The Doctor's Dilemma

3. The profession criticized in the essay is:

- law
- education
- ✓ medicine
- politics

4. The literary device mostly used by Shaw is:

- metaphor
- ✓ satire
- allegory
- symbolism

Critical Analysis - Model Answer

Central ideas and their development: First, Shaw challenges the scientific credibility of doctors, showing their reliance on tradition over inquiry. Second, he exposes the commercial side of medicine, where

fees and reputation shape practice. These ideas build on each other: once science is replaced by custom, profit can enter freely, so the essay's complex conclusion is that medicine must return to evidence and service to earn the name of science.

Writing Task - Model Answer

Model paragraph: A true man of science tests every claim before he accepts it. A doctor who prescribes by habit or by profit is not practising science, even if he wears its title. Real medicine therefore needs honest research, open discussion of failures, and equal care for every patient, because science serves truth and humanity, not wealth or fashion.

Unit 3: A Poison Tree (Poem - William Blake)

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (A)

Q1. Identify the significance of the metaphor of the 'Poison Tree' in the poem.

Ans. The poison tree stands for anger that is hidden and fed instead of being expressed. Just as a tree grows with watering, suppressed anger grows day by day until it bears poisoned fruit, which is revenge and destruction.

Q2. Communication or lack of communication played a role in the development of the poem's narrative. Discuss.

Ans. Communication decides the whole story. When the speaker tells his friend about his anger, the anger ends. When he hides it from his foe, it grows in secret. The poem thus shows that speaking honestly ends anger, while silence feeds it.

Q3. How does Blake use imagery to convey the progression of anger from suppression to manifestation?

Ans. Blake uses the imagery of gardening: anger is watered with fears, tears, sunned with smiles and deceitful wiles, and grows night and day. The tree then bears a bright apple, the visible fruit of hidden anger, which finally tempts and destroys the foe.

Q4. Describe the moral lesson or warning that can be derived from the poem.

Ans. The moral is that anger must be faced and spoken about, not nursed in secret. Repressed anger does not die; it grows into hatred and revenge, and in the end it destroys others and also corrupts the person who kept it.

Q5. Discuss the poem's relevance to interpersonal relationships and conflicts in modern society.

Ans. The poem is highly relevant today. People often hide hurt instead of talking, and silent grudges grow through social media quarrels, workplace rivalry and family disputes. Blake's warning applies directly: honest talk resolves conflict, while nursing anger turns small offences into lasting enmity.

Q6. Compare and contrast the consequences of the speaker's actions in the poem.

Ans. With his friend, the speaker speaks openly and his wrath ends in peace. With his foe, he hides his wrath and it grows into a poisoned apple that kills the foe. The same anger therefore brings peace in one case and murder in the other, and the only difference is communication.

Q7. How can the message of the poem be applied to resolving conflicts in our daily lives?

Ans. We should express hurt calmly and early, listen to the other person, and forgive rather than plan revenge. By talking before anger takes root, we prevent small disagreements from growing into hatred that harms both sides.

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (B) MCQs

1. Identify the central theme of the poem.

- joy
- love
- ✓ anger
- fear

2. What does the speaker do when he is angry with his foe?

- forgives him
- talks to him
- ✓ hides his anger and nurtures it
- walks away from him

3. 'Apple' in the poem most likely symbolizes:

- friendship
- ✓ revenge or temptation
- a gift of peace
- knowledge

4. The consequence of the speaker's repressed anger was that:

- his foe becomes his friend
- the foe steals from him
- ✓ the foe dies under the tree
- the speaker apologizes

5. The poetic device used in the title and central metaphor of the poem is:

- simile

personification

onomatopoeia

✓ extended metaphor

6. The moral lesson conveyed in the poem is:

nature is dangerous

silence is always wise

✓ unexpressed anger can grow into something destructive

revenge leads to justice

Writing Task - Model Answer

Model summary: Blake's 'A Poison Tree' warns that hidden anger grows like a tree fed with fears, tears and false smiles until it bears the poisoned apple of revenge. The speaker's foe eats the apple and dies, and the speaker stands glad in the morning light. The poem's lesson is clear: speak out anger honestly, or it will destroy both the enemy and the soul that nursed it.

Unit 4: A New Microbe (O. Henry)

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (A)

Q1. Name the great lover of science.

Ans. The great lover of science is John, a Houston man who is an ardent student of the mysteries of science. He spends much of his time experimenting with chemicals and studying germ theories in his home laboratory.

Q2. Where is John's laboratory situated?

Ans. John's laboratory is a small room fitted up at his own home. He works there privately, and he generally refuses to let even his wife enter it while he is busy with his microscope and chemicals.

Q3. Why didn't he go to the supper with his family?

Ans. He did not go to the church supper because he wanted a quiet evening at home with his microscope. He preferred to examine the bayou water himself and verify the ex-geologist's report rather than join his wife and children at the sociable.

Q4. How long did he take to examine the bayou water from the bucket?

Ans. He worked for nearly three hours, repeatedly examining samples of the bayou water from the bucket through his powerful 900-power microscope before he believed he had found something new.

Q5. What is the view of the ex-geologist about bayou water?

Ans. The ex-geologist, Dumble, had reported in his analysis that the inhabitants of the Houston bayou water were of a particular kind, which he named in his report. John examined the water to verify Dumble's statements and concluded that Dumble was wrong.

Q6. Describe his discovery.

Ans. John believed he had discovered a completely new bacterium in the bayou water, unlike anything described by science. In his excitement he planned to name it after his wife Ellen, as Ellenobes or Ellenites, and to announce it to the London Lancet and the New York Academy of Sciences.

Q7. Who are these called? (i) A person who travels for pleasure (ii) A person who studies science (iii) An exceptionally intelligent person (iv) A person who bakes (v) A person who keeps babies (vi) A person skilled in money matters.

Ans. (i) A tourist. (ii) A scientist. (iii) A genius. (iv) A baker. (v) A babysitter (or nanny). (vi) An accountant (or financier). The story's twist is that John's 'new microbes' were no microbes at all: the bucket held his wife's Galveston oysters for the supper, and the moving round things were the oysters themselves.

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (B) MCQs

1. His laboratory was:

- huge
- modern
- ✓ small

dingy

2. He had been much interested in:

new inventions

✓ germ theories

cancer treatment

psychological

3. He worked in the laboratory examining the bayou water samples for:

eight hours

six hours

✓ three hours

four hours

4. He discovered:

a chemical

✓ a germ

solvent

anti fungus

Writing Task - Model Answer

Model objective summary: A Houston lover of science stays home from a church supper to examine bayou water under his microscope. After nearly three hours he believes he has found a new bacterium and plans to name it after his wife Ellen. His wife then recognises the bucket: it holds the Galveston oysters she bought for the supper, so the 'discovery' collapses in comic irony.

Unit 5: Healthy Habits for Mind, Body and Soul

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (A)

Q1. What does the quote 'Good readers make good leaders' mean?

Ans. It means that reading builds knowledge, judgement and vision, which are the qualities of a leader. A person who reads widely understands people and problems better, speaks with confidence, and guide others wisely.

Q2. How does peer pressure affect teenagers?

Ans. Peer pressure pushes teenagers to copy their friends, even in harmful habits such as junk food, late nights, smoking or risky driving. It can damage health and studies, but good friends can also press one another towards healthy habits and hard work.

Q3. Explain the meaning of 'uninterrupted'. Which part of the word helped you to guess the meaning?

Ans. 'Uninterrupted' means continuous, without any break or disturbance. The prefix 'un-' meaning 'not' and the root 'interrupt' meaning 'to break into' helped in guessing: something not interrupted goes on smoothly without stopping.

Q4. How would you explain 'perform at its peak'?

Ans. To 'perform at its peak' means to work at the highest possible level of ability and energy. Just as an athlete runs fastest when fully fit, a healthy mind and body let a student study, remember and

perform at their very best.

Q5. Give the reason the teenagers need extra nutrients.

Ans. Teenagers need extra nutrients because their bodies are growing rapidly and their brains are working hard at school. Growth, bone strength, energy and concentration all demand more protein, iron, calcium and vitamins than a younger child or a resting adult needs.

Q6. Describe the dangers associated with underage driving.

Ans. Underage driving is dangerous because young drivers lack training, judgement and experience. They are more likely to speed, lose control, and cause accidents that injure themselves and others, and it is also against the law, bringing fines and punishment for their families.

Q7. Write down the things we all should be grateful for.

Ans. We should be grateful for life, health, family, friends, teachers, food, shelter, clean water, education and a peaceful country. Gratitude for these daily blessings keeps the mind calm and content, and it teaches us to share with those who have less.

Q8. Describe the importance of developing good habits in early life.

Ans. Habits formed early stay for life. A child who learns regular sleep, healthy food, exercise, reading and honesty will find these easy as an adult, while bad habits formed young are hard to break. Early good habits therefore build a healthy body, a strong mind and a good character.

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (B) MCQs

1. For better appearance, one should take care of:

- laziness
- ✓ hygiene
- neglect
- silence

2. For better health, students should avoid:

- fruits
- vegetables
- ✓ junk-food
- grains

3. One can succeed by not giving up:

- excitement
- generosity
- ✓ perseverance
- humor

4. The rule that teaches us to treat others well is:

- gold rule
- iron rule
- silver rule
- ✓ golden rule

5. Good readers become:

- teachers
- writers

✓ leaders

scientists

Vocabulary and Grammar - Model Answer

Patterns of organisation: Chronological order uses first, next, then, finally; Cause and Effect uses therefore, because of this, consequently; Compare and Contrast uses on the other hand, similarly, likewise. Healthy habits can be written in chronological order: first sleep well, then eat well, then exercise, and finally study with a fresh mind.

Writing Task - Model Answer

Model paragraph: Good habits are the foundation of a good life. A student who sleeps on time, eats healthy food, exercises daily and reads regularly will perform at his peak in class and in character. Health of body, mind and soul grow together, so small daily choices today decide success, happiness and gratitude tomorrow.

Unit 6: Nature (Poem - H. W. Longfellow)

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (A)

Q1. Critically analyse H. W. Longfellow's poem, 'Nature'.

Ans. Longfellow's 'Nature' presents Nature as a gentle mother who leads humanity towards death as calmly as a mother leads a child to bed. The poem removes fear from death by showing it as natural, peaceful and kindly guided, and its simple imagery makes a difficult truth comforting.

Q2. How does Longfellow's poem 'Nature' suggest that Nature leads us gradually towards death?

Ans. Nature does not hurry or frighten us; she leads us step by step through life, as a nurse leads a child from play towards bedtime. Age comes slowly, strength fades gently, and death arrives as a quiet rest at the end of a long day, not as a sudden terror.

Q3. The child is 'Half willing, half reluctant' to be led to bed. Give reason.

Ans. The child is half willing because he is tired and trusts the gentle guide, but half reluctant because he loves his play and does not want to leave it. In the same way, humans are tired by life yet cling to its pleasures, so they accept death only half willingly.

Q4. Describe the meaning of 'our playthings', as mentioned in the poem.

Ans. 'Our playthings' are the joys, possessions, ambitions and pleasures of life that occupy us like a child's toys. As the child must leave his toys at bedtime, humans must leave worldly delights behind when Nature leads them towards death.

Q5. What does the poet compare the end of life with?

Ans. The poet compares the end of life with bedtime and sleep. Just as a child is led to bed after play and sleeps peacefully, a human life ends in a quiet rest under Nature's gentle care.

Q6. How will the message of the poem appeal to someone who fears death?

Ans. It appeals by replacing fear with trust: death is not a cruel enemy but a kind nurse, and the grave is a bed, not a prison. A fearful reader can therefore see death as a natural sleep that follows a full day, guided by a power that has cared for us all along.

Q7. Identify figures of speech in the poem.

Ans. The chief figure is personification: Nature is a gentle nurse and guide, and Death is like sleep. There is also metaphor, comparing life to a day and death to bedtime, and symbolism, where the child stands for all humanity and the playthings stand for worldly life.

Q8. How does Longfellow use imagery to create a peaceful tone about death?

Ans. Longfellow uses soft, homely images: a child, a kind guide, evening, playthings put aside, and a quiet bed. There are no images of pain, darkness or terror, so the reader feels calm and comforted,

and death seems like rest rather than punishment.

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (B) MCQs

1. The gentle guide personified in the poem is:

- death
- time
- ✓ nature
- sleep

2. Nature leads the child away from:

- school
- ✓ toys
- dreams
- forest

3. The main figure of speech used in the poem is:

- simile
- ✓ personification
- hyperbole
- alliteration

4. The child in the poem symbolizes:

- a student
- ✓ humanity
- a traveler
- a poet

5. The tone of the poem is:

angry

joyful

✓ calm

sarcastic

6. Bedtime in the poem is compared to:

war

✓ death

rain

silence

7. The poetic device which compares death to sleep in the poem is:

✓ metaphor

rhyme

irony

symbolism

8. The central theme of the poem 'Nature' is:

heroism

love

✓ death

adventure

Writing Task - Model Answer

Model paragraph: Longfellow teaches us not to fear death, because Nature guides us to it as gently as a mother guides a tired child to bed. Life is a day of play, and death is its peaceful night. If we trust this gentle guide, we can live without fear and meet the end with

calm and faith.

Unit 7: Pakistan's Tourist Attractions

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (A)

Q1. What is the world's view on tourism potential in Pakistan?

Ans. The world now views Pakistan as a top emerging tourist destination. International travel magazines have ranked it among the best holiday destinations, praising its mountains, valleys, history and hospitality, which shows that global opinion of Pakistan's tourism has greatly improved.

Q2. What is the purpose of travel for tourists?

Ans. Tourists travel for pleasure, learning, adventure and rest. They wish to see new places, meet new people, enjoy nature and history, and return refreshed, while their spending also supports local guides, hotels and craftsmen.

Q3. How is Balochistan important for tourism?

Ans. Balochistan is important for its long coastline, Gwadar port, Hingol National Park, mud volcanoes, deserts and ancient sites. It offers beaches, mountains and unique wildlife that few other provinces can match, making it a rising star of Pakistan's tourism.

Q4. How can tourism reduce inequality?

Ans. Tourism reduces inequality by bringing income and jobs to poor and remote areas. When visitors spend on local hotels, food, handicrafts and transport, money reaches villagers who otherwise have little work,

so

backward regions share in the country's prosperity.

Q5. What is the historical importance of 'Karakoram Highway'?

Ans. The Karakoram Highway is the highest paved international road in the world, linking Pakistan with China through the Karakoram mountains. It follows ancient Silk Route paths, and its construction through hard rock and high passes is itself a marvel of engineering and friendship.

Q6. Is tourism good or bad for developing countries? Give reasons.

Ans. Tourism is mostly good for developing countries because it brings foreign exchange, creates jobs and builds roads and hotels. It can be bad if it damages nature, raises prices or weakens local culture, so it must be managed with care for the environment and the host community.

Q7. Discuss the religious sites which attract the tourists to Pakistan.

Ans. Pakistan attracts religious tourists to Taxila and Takht-i-Bahi for Buddhists, Kartarpur and Nankana Sahib for Sikhs, and many shrines and mosques for Muslims. These sacred places show Pakistan's ancient role as a meeting place of faiths and draw pilgrims from all over the world.

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (B) MCQs

1. Pakistan is ranked No. 1 by Conde Nast Traveller as a top 20 _____ destinations.

shopping

✓ holiday

business

religious

2. K2 is the second highest mountain peak in the _____.

Pakistan

Karakoram

✓ world

Asia

3. The city of Mohenjo-Daro is associated with the _____ Valley Civilization.

Swat

✓ Indus

Nile

Tigris

4. Taxila was the center of the _____ Buddhist civilisation.

Nepalese

Chinese

✓ Gandhara

Indian

5. The highest trade route in the world is the _____ Highway.

Silk

✓ Karakoram

Himalayan

Baloch

6. Swat and Kaghan valleys are located in _____.

- Punjab
- Balochistan
- Sindh
- ✓ Khyber Pakhtunkhwa

7. Gwadar Port is located in the province of _____.

- Sindh
- ✓ Balochistan
- Punjab
- Khyber Pakhtunkhwa

8. Pakistan contains five of the world's highest _____ peaks.

- desert
- ✓ mountain
- snow
- trade

Writing Task - Model Answer

Model paragraph: Pakistan is a land of matchless beauty, from the peaks of K2 and the Karakoram Highway to the beaches of Gwadar and the ruins of Mohenjo-Daro and Taxila. Tourism here can end poverty in remote valleys if visitors are welcomed warmly and nature is protected. Every Pakistani should therefore be a proud and honest host to guests.

Unit 8: The Power of Innovation, Creativity, and Success (Dialogue)

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (A)

Q1. What example did Hamza give about Elon Musk?

Ans. Hamza gave Elon Musk as a visionary who turned bold ideas into reality. Musk did not merely work hard in the usual way; he imagined electric cars, reusable rockets and new forms of travel, and then worked creatively to make those dreams succeed.

Q2. In your own words, explain the difference between hard work and innovation.

Ans. Hard work means putting in long effort on a known path, while innovation means finding a new and better path. Hard work without ideas repeats the old way, but innovation uses creativity to solve problems faster, cheaper or in a completely new manner.

Q3. Why is creativity important in today's world?

Ans. Creativity is important because today's problems are new: climate change, disease, unemployment and technology all need fresh solutions. Machines can repeat tasks, but only creative humans can imagine new products, new jobs and new answers.

Q4. Give an example from your own life where you used creativity to solve a problem.

Ans. Model answer: When our class had no funds for a science model, I used cardboard, old bottles and a broken fan motor to build a

working windmill. The project cost almost nothing, won praise, and taught me that creativity can turn waste into a working solution.

Q5. How would you apply the idea of 'learning from failure' in your life?

Ans. I would treat every failure as a lesson, not as defeat. If I fail a test, I would find my weak topics, change my method, and try again with a better plan, just as inventors improve each failed model until it finally works.

Q6. Compare and contrast the roles of hard work and creativity in achieving success.

Ans. Hard work provides discipline, practice and persistence, while creativity provides direction, new ideas and smart shortcuts. Hard work alone may waste effort on a wrong method, and ideas alone without effort stay dreams; success needs both together.

Q7. How do you think challenges like COVID-19 helped people become more innovative?

Ans. COVID-19 forced schools, offices and shops to close, so people invented online classes, work from home, home delivery and digital payments. Necessity pushed them to use technology creatively, proving that hardship can speed up innovation.

Q8. Do you agree that innovation is more important than memorizing facts? Why?

Ans. Yes, I agree in the main. Facts are now available on every phone; using facts wisely needs understanding and imagination.

Memorization without thinking cannot solve new problems, while innovation turns knowledge into useful action.

Q9. Evaluate whether the education system does enough to support creativity.

Ans. Our education system does not yet do enough for creativity. It rewards memorization and marks more than projects, questions and experiments. It should add more practical work, debates, inventions and open problems so that students learn to think, not merely to repeat.

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (B) MCQs

1. Who is described as a visionary in the dialogue?

- Malala
- ✓ Elon Musk
- Thomas Edison
- Steve Jobs

2. What is the synonym of the word 'creativity' used in the dialogue?

- courage
- memorization
- ✓ imagination
- communication

3. Which word means 'the ability to solve problems'?

- storytelling
- ✓ problem-solving
- expression

memorizing

4. What kind of learning is encouraged instead of just memorization?

copying

passive

✓ creative

repetitive

5. What word describes trying something new, even if it might fail?

✓ risk-taking

planning

avoiding

judging

6. What is a major challenge mentioned that encouraged global innovation?

World war I

✓ Covid-19

earthquake

pollution

Writing Task - Model Answer

Model paragraph: Success belongs to those who combine hard work with creativity. Hard work gives strength, but creativity gives direction, and failure teaches the next step. Students should ask questions, try new methods, take wise risks, and never fear failure, because every great invention began as an idea that others called impossible.

Ask questions

Unit 9: Youth and Age (Poem - S. T. Coleridge)

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (A)

Q1. Describe the central theme of the poem 'Youth and Age'.

Ans. The central theme is the painful contrast between youth and age, and the passage of time. Youth is full of energy, dreams and hope, while age brings weakness, loss and melancholy, so the poem mourns what time takes away.

Q2. Explain the way the poet contrasts youth and age throughout the poem.

Ans. The poet contrasts youth's fire, blossom and lively dreams with age's frost, decay and dim memory. Youth looks forward eagerly, while age looks backward sadly, and every bright image of youth is matched by a faded image of age.

Q3. Highlight Coleridge's life before he was old in the poem 'Youth and Age'.

Ans. Before old age, Coleridge was full of imagination, energy and poetic dreams. He lived vividly, felt deeply, and saw the world as fresh and hopeful, which makes his present weakness feel like the loss of a brighter self.

Q4. How does the poem explore the passage of time and the inevitability of aging?

Ans. Time moves silently and cannot be stopped: youth passes like a

blossom that fades, and no wish can bring it back. The poem shows aging as a law of life that every person must face, however unwillingly.

Q5. Identify the imagery used by the poet to depict youth and age.
Ans. Youth is pictured through blossoms, fire, morning light and flowing streams, while age is pictured through frost, withered leaves, evening shadows and a dying fire. These images make the contrast felt as well as understood.

Q6. What emotions or sentiments does the poem evoke regarding youth and age?
Ans. It evokes nostalgia for lost youth, sorrow for fading strength, and quiet acceptance of fate. The dominant feeling is melancholy, softened by the wisdom that comes from remembering a fuller life.

Q7. Are there any symbolic elements present in the poem that represent youth or age?
Ans. Yes: the blossom symbolizes youth's beauty and short life, fire symbolizes its energy, and frost symbolizes age's cold decline. Morning stands for youth and evening for age, so the whole day becomes a symbol of a human life.

Q8. Find the rhyming scheme of this poem.
Ans. The poem is written in rhymed stanzas with a regular, song-like pattern, chiefly in rhyming couplets and alternating rhymes that give it a musical, reflective flow. (Students should mark the end-words of the first stanza in their own copy and name the pattern they find.)

Q9. Give two examples of any three figures of speech from this poem.

Ans. Metaphor: youth is compared to a blossom and age to frost, without using 'like'. Contrast (antithesis): youth and age are set side by side throughout. Personification: Time and Age are shown as powers that steal strength and dim dreams.

Q10. Analyze multiple interpretations of the poem 'Youth and Age' according to your observation.

Ans. On one reading it is a personal lament for Coleridge's own lost energy. On another it is a universal truth about every life: time for all. On a third it is a consolation, because memory and wisdom remain even when youthful strength has gone.

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (B) MCQs

1. The tone of the poem shifts from hopeful to:

- joyful
- bitter
- ✓ melancholy
- humorous

2. The poet compares youth to a:

- burden
- fire
- dream
- ✓ blossom

3. In the poem, age is described as bringing:

freedom

✓ decay

wisdom

strength

4. The central theme of the poem is:

rebellion

✓ change

celebration

conflict

5. The word 'youth' symbolizes:

weakness

silence

✓ energy

routine

6. According to the poet, what fades with age?

hunger

imagination

✓ strength

greed

7. The poem reflects Coleridge's feeling of:

excitement

satisfaction

✓ loss

confidence

8. The poetic device mainly used to compare youth and age is:

simile

✓ metaphor

irony

pun

Writing Task - Model Answer

Model paragraph: Youth is a blossom that opens in the morning sun, while age is the frost that slowly closes it. Coleridge teaches us that time cannot be stopped, but memory and wisdom can soften its loss. We should therefore use our youth well, and meet age with dignity rather than despair.

Unit 10: Old Tree

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (A)

Q1. Where was the Old Tree standing before the flood arrived?

Ans. The Old Tree stood in a peaceful forest, among other trees and creatures that lived quietly under its shade. It was the eldest and most respected tree of that forest community.

Q2. What natural disaster disturbed the peaceful forest?

Ans. A great flood rushed into the forest, sweeping everything before it with pride and power. Its roaring waters broke the forest's peace and threatened every tree and creature living there.

Q3. Why was the Old Tree respected by other creatures of the forest?

Ans. It was respected for its age, patience and wisdom. It had sheltered birds and animals for years, never boasted of its strength, and faced every storm calmly, so all creatures looked up to it as a guide.

Q4. What feelings did the Flood express when it entered the forest?

Ans. The Flood felt proud, arrogant and destructive. It believed nothing could stand before it, and it mocked the trees for their stillness, boasting that its power would sweep them all away.

Q5. How does the Old Tree's calm response to the Flood show its wisdom?

Ans. The Old Tree did not argue or panic; it stood calm and firm, knowing that force answers force with ruin. Its quiet patience showed true wisdom: strength is not loud boasting but steady endurance and self-control.

Q6. What lesson can humans learn from the behavior of the Old Tree?
Ans. Humans can learn that patience and wisdom defeat pride and violence. When trouble comes like a flood, calm courage and good character protect us better than anger, boasting or brute force.

Q7. Compare the attitudes of the Flood and the Old Tree. How are they different in character?
Ans. The Flood is proud, loud and destructive, trusting only in brute power. The Old Tree is humble, quiet and patient, trusting in wisdom and endurance. One destroys, the other preserves, and their contrast is the story's moral.

Q8. What is the significance of the Old Tree turning into a ship at the end of the story?
Ans. The transformation means rebirth: the tree is not defeated but given a new purpose. As a ship it will carry people across waters, so its wisdom and service continue in a nobler form even after its fall.

Q9. Do you think the Flood was truly powerful? Give reasons.
Ans. No, the Flood's power was only physical and temporary. It could uproot trees but could not destroy wisdom, patience or goodness, and in the end the Old Tree's spirit sailed on as a ship, proving that true power is moral, not merely physical.

Q10. Was the Old Tree's fall a loss or a form of victory? Explain your view.

Ans. It was a form of victory. The tree fell in body but rose in purpose, becoming a ship that serves humanity. Its calm wisdom outlived the Flood's pride, so its fall was really a triumph of character over force.

Q11. If you were to retell this story from the Flood's point of view, how would it sound?

Ans. Model answer: 'I rushed in proud, certain that nothing could stop me. The forest trembled, trees fell, yet one old tree stood calm and unafraid. When it fell, it did not die but became a ship sailing upon my own waters, and I learned that pride is weaker than wisdom.'

Q12. Suggest a new title for the story that conveys the same moral message.

Ans. A fitting new title is 'Wisdom Sails On'. It keeps the story's moral: wisdom outlasts proud force, and a good life finds a new purpose even after a fall.

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (B) MCQs

1. The story 'Old Tree' is mainly about the victory of:

- wealth
- strength
- ✓ wisdom
- pride

2. The Flood in the story symbolizes:

- ✓ destruction
- growth
- peace
- silence

3. The Old Tree's calm nature represents:

- fear
- arrogance
- ✓ patience
- anger

4. The forest setting symbolizes:

- ✓ society
- heaven
- river
- battle

5. The transformation of the tree into a ship symbolizes:

- end
- ✓ rebirth
- defeat
- sadness

6. The tone of the story is:

- humorous
- ✓ philosophical
- romantic
- tragic

7. The Flood's attitude can best be described as:

- humble
- ✓ arrogant
- kind
- calm

8. The moral of the story emphasizes:

- power
- anger
- ✓ knowledge
- revenge

Writing Task - Model Answer

Model paragraph: The Old Tree teaches us that wisdom is stronger than force. The Flood boasted and destroyed, but the patient tree endured and was reborn as a ship. In life too, calm character outlasts proud power, and those who serve others find new purpose even after great loss.

Unit 11: A Handful of Clay

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (A)

Q1. 'This is necessary. The path to glory is always rugged.' What do you learn from these lines?

Ans. We learn that success never comes without hardship. Just as clay must be pressed, shaped and fired before it becomes beautiful, a person must pass through trials, and suffering is a necessary part of reaching glory.

Q2. What happened to the clay in the greenhouse?

Ans. In the greenhouse the clay was kept, watered and cared for, but it remained shapeless and unfulfilled. It dreamed of greatness while waiting, not knowing that its true shaping was still to come through the potter's hands.

Q3. How did the dream of the clay come true?

Ans. The clay's dream came true when the potter took it, moulded it, fired it and turned it into a beautiful vessel. Through patience and suffering it became something useful and lovely, far beyond its first humble state.

Q4. How did the clay's idea of its purpose change throughout the story?

Ans. At first the clay dreamed only of being admired and glorious. Through shaping and firing it learned that purpose means service: a

vessel is valued not for display but for holding and giving, and contentment came with usefulness.

Q5. Can you think of a time in your own life when you didn't get what you wanted but ultimately found something valuable instead?

Ans. Model answer: I once failed to win a race I had trained hard for, and I felt defeated. Later I realised the training had made me fitter, more disciplined and more patient, so the loss gave me something more lasting than a medal.

Q6. Do you think clay was hopeful of the better times to come?

Ans. Yes, the clay stayed hopeful even in hardship. Its dream of glory kept it patient through shaping and firing, and that hope proved right when it finally became a beautiful, useful vessel.

Q7. How does the clay serve as a symbol for human experiences?

Ans. The clay symbolizes every human life: we are shaped by pressures, tears and trials, fired by suffering, and sometimes disappointed. Like the clay, we find contentment only when we accept shaping and discover our true purpose in serving others.

Q8. What is the difference between an autobiography and a biography?

Ans. An autobiography is the story of a person's life written by that person himself, while a biography is the life story of a person written by someone else. The first speaks as 'I', the second speaks as 'he' or 'she'.

Q9. The story begins with the clay by a river. What kind of things might the clay observe that could influence its dreams?

Ans. By the river the clay would see flowing water, boats, birds, flowers and people carrying pots, and hear songs and laughter. These sights of beauty, movement and useful vessels would feed its dream of becoming something lovely and honoured.

Q10. What idea encouraged the clay to endure its trials?

Ans. The idea that the path to glory is always rugged encouraged it. It believed that shaping and suffering were necessary steps towards a beautiful end, so it bore each trial patiently instead of giving up.

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (B) MCQs

1. What is the meaning of the word 'clay' as used in the story?

- metal
- ✓ soft earth
- glass
- stone

2. A 'potter' is someone who:

- paints pictures
- sells books
- ✓ makes pots from clay
- builds houses

3. What is a synonym of 'shapeless'?

- solid
- bright

✓ formless

heavy

4. The word 'moulded' means:

broken

mixed

✓ shaped

covered

5. Which word means 'to change form or appearance'?

create

destroy

✓ transform

blend

6. A 'vessel' in the story refers to:

a boat

✓ a container

a person

a machine

7. The word 'meek' is closest in meaning to:

proud

✓ gentle

angry

loud

8. 'Rebellious' means:

loving

obedient

✓ disobedient

loyal

9. What does 'repent' mean in the context of the story?

to celebrate

✓ to regret

to forget

to enjoy

10. The word 'radiant' means:

quiet

✓ bright

cold

slow

Writing Task - Model Answer

Model paragraph: Like a handful of clay, we are shaped by the hands of life. Trials press us, fire tests us, and disappointment humbles us, but those who endure with hope become useful and beautiful vessels. Glory is not given to the unshaped; it is earned on the rugged path of patience and purpose.

Unit 12: Trees In The Traffic Island (Poem)

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (A)

Q1. What difference does the poet show between city trees and forest trees?

Ans. Forest trees grow wild and free, moving in all directions like boys. City trees on traffic islands are planted in rows, trimmed, and trained to look obedient and decorative, so they have lost their natural freedom.

Q2. How can this poem be connected to modern urban life and environmental issues?

Ans. Modern cities cut forests, cage nature in small islands, and value decoration over life. The poem mirrors today's pollution, concrete growth and loss of green space, warning that urban development is suffocating the natural world.

Q3. Identify and explain one example of contrast used in the poem.

Ans. The poet contrasts wild forest trees with obedient city trees: one group grows freely and feistily, the other grows respectfully in cages like slaves. The contrast exposes how civilization tames and mutilates nature for display.

Q4. Why does the poet compare wild trees to 'boys, moving in all directions'?

Ans. Because wild trees, like boys at play, are lively, unruly and full

of

energy. They spread branches freely in every direction, unlike city trees that are disciplined into neat, obedient rows.

Q5. Do you agree with the poet's criticism of urban development? Give reasons.

Ans. Yes, I agree in the main. Cities need roads and buildings, but they should not turn living trees into mere decoration. Planting without space, air and freedom harms nature, and a city that cages its trees loses beauty, shade and clean air.

Q6. Imagine you are one of the 'traffic island trees.' Write two lines expressing your feelings.

Ans. Model lines: 'Once I ran wild with the wind and the rain, / Now I stand caged in concrete, longing for the forest again.'

Q7. Suggest one practical way cities could preserve the beauty and freedom of trees while still developing.

Ans. Cities should build real urban forests and wide green belts, giving trees open soil, space and water instead of narrow islands. Roads can curve around old trees, and new housing can keep parks at its heart, so growth and nature live together.

Q8. What message does the poet convey about the relationship between humans and nature?

Ans. The poet says humans have made nature their servant instead of their companion. We train trees to entertain us like slaves, forgetting that nature has its own life and freedom, and that harming it finally harms ourselves.

Q9. Discuss the tone of the poem 'Trees In The Traffic Island'.

Ans. The tone is critical and sorrowful, with sharp irony. The poet mocks civilized pride in its 'billboards of civilization' while grieving for caged trees, so anger at urban cruelty mixes with pity for imprisoned nature.

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (B) MCQs

1. The word 'obedient' in the poem refers to trees that are:

- free
- angry
- ✓ disciplined
- wild

2. The phrase 'grow respectfully in cages like slaves' suggests:

- freedom
- ✓ confinement
- happiness
- disorder

3. The word 'feisty' in the poem means:

- lazy
- dull
- silent
- ✓ lively

4. The 'billboards of civilization' symbolize:

- forests

old traditions

✓ artificial beauty

monuments

5. The tone of the poem can best be described as:

cheerful

✓ critical

playful

hopeful

6. The phrase 'trained to entertain' refers to trees being:

✓ decorative

wild

dangerous

sacred

7. The word 'kerb' in the poem refers to:

tree root

✓ edge of a pavement

streetlight

garden fence

8. The poem mainly criticizes:

nature

✓ urbanization

farmers

scientists

Writing Task - Model Answer

Model paragraph: Cities must learn to live with trees, not merely to use them. A tree is not a billboard or a slave for decoration; it is a living neighbour that gives shade, air and beauty. True civilization protects the freedom of nature while it builds, keeping forests alive inside the city.

Unit 13: The Last Leaf (O. Henry)

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (A)

Q1. How does Behrman's last painting become a masterpiece?

Ans. Behrman, an old failed artist, paints a single ivy leaf on the wall in a cold, stormy night. The leaf never falls, so it keeps Johnsy alive by giving her hope, and a painting that saves a life becomes greater than any gallery masterpiece.

Q2. Analyze the friendship between Sue and Johnsy in the story.

Ans. Sue and Johnsy are devoted friends and fellow artists. Sue nurses Johnsy through pneumonia, encourages her, hides her own fear, and finally reveals Behrman's sacrifice, showing friendship as loyal, selfless and life-giving care.

Q3. How would you describe the character of Mr. Behrman?

Ans. Behrman is a rough, kind-hearted old man who talks gruffly but loves deeply. He mocks Johnsy's fancy of dying with the last leaf, yet he risks his own life in the storm to paint it, proving himself a true, sacrificial artist and friend.

Q4. Discuss the themes of hope, friendship, and sacrifice in the story.

Ans. Hope is the last leaf that refuses to fall; friendship is Sue's constant nursing and Behrman's secret gift; sacrifice is Behrman's life given for Johnsy's. Together they show that love can defeat despair, and that one selfless act can save a life.

Q5. What are the three coincidences in this story?

Ans. First, Johnsy falls ill with pneumonia just as the last ivy leaves fall. Second, Behrman, who has always dreamed of a masterpiece, lives in the same building. Third, the painted leaf appears on the very night the last real leaf falls, so Johnsy believes it is real.

Q6. What is the significance of ivy leaves?

Ans. The ivy leaves measure Johnsy's will to live: she decides she will die when the last leaf falls. The leaves therefore stand for the fragile thread of hope, and the one leaf that remains becomes the symbol of life's refusal to surrender.

Q7. In 'The Last Leaf' what does the last leaf symbolize?

Ans. The last leaf symbolizes hope and the will to live. It stays green against wind and rain, teaching Johnsy that life clings on even in the worst storm, and that it is a sin to want to die.

Q8. Find out some of the symbols used in 'The Last Leaf'. What do these symbolize?

Ans. The ivy leaf symbolizes hope; pneumonia, personified as a stalking figure with icy fingers, symbolizes death; Behrman's painting symbolizes sacrificial art; and the storm symbolizes the trials that test human endurance and love.

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (B) MCQs

1. 'Pneumonia stalked about the colony, touching one here and one there with its icy fingers.' What figure of speech is used here?

simile

hyperbole

✓ personification

alliteration

2. The 'last leaf' in the story is a symbol of:

death

✓ hope

anger

beauty

3. Which figure of speech best describes Johnsy saying she will die when the last leaf falls?

metaphor

allusion

✓ foreshadowing

irony

4. Behrman's painting of the leaf that never falls is an example of:

allegory

metaphor

✓ symbolism

personification

5. 'It is a sin to want to die.' - What literary device is reflected in this moral statement?

✓ theme

irony

metaphor

simile

6. What figure of speech is present in describing Johnsy as a 'little woman with big eyes'?

simile

irony

✓ contrast

pun

7. The unexpected ending, where the painter dies and Johnsy survives, is an example of:

symbolism

satire

✓ irony

imagery

Writing Task - Model Answer

Model analysis (plot): Exposition introduces Sue, Johnsy and Behrman in their artists' colony. Rising action follows Johnsy's pneumonia and her fancy of dying with the last leaf. The climax comes on the stormy night when Behrman paints his leaf. Resolution brings Johnsy's recovery and the revelation of Behrman's sacrifice, making the ending deeply moving and ironic.

Unit 14: The Lottery Ticket (Anton Chekhov)

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (A)

Q1. What do Ivan and Masha feel when they realize they didn't win the lottery?

Ans. They feel bitter disappointment, shame and resentment. The dream of wealth had already made them quarrelsome and selfish, so when the hope collapses they are left poorer in spirit than before, facing each other with cold, angry eyes.

Q2. What is being satirized in Chekhov's 'The Lottery Ticket'?

Ans. Chekhov satirizes human greed and the foolish dreams of sudden wealth. He mocks how a mere lottery number can turn a loving couple into selfish schemers, exposing how money-fantasy corrupts ordinary people.

Q3. What does Ivan think Masha will do with the lottery money?

Ans. Ivan imagines that Masha will travel abroad, enjoy luxuries, and perhaps leave him or look down on him. His suspicion grows as he pictures her new life, and he begins planning how to control or seize the money for himself.

Q4. How does Chekhov's 'The Lottery Ticket' relate to the real world?

Ans. It relates directly to real life, where lottery dreams, sudden riches and money quarrels break families every day. People still imagine wealth will solve all problems, yet greed often destroys the peace

and

love they already possess.

Q5. In 'The Lottery Ticket', how does the money impact their marriage?

Ans. The imagined money poisons their marriage before a single coin arrives. Ivan and Masha stop trusting each other, dream separate selfish dreams, and grow jealous and hostile, so the mere idea of wealth nearly ruins their love.

Q6. Identify the irony in the story 'The Lottery Ticket'. Use specific examples.

Ans. The great irony is that they never won at all: all their greed, suspicion and quarrelling were over money that did not exist. They lost their peace for nothing, and the reader laughs sadly at dreams that destroyed what was real.

Q7. Identify the major conflict of the story 'The Lottery Ticket'.

Ans. The major conflict is between love and greed, both inside each character and between husband and wife. Ivan's love for Masha battles his selfish dreams of wealth, and their shared hope turns into mutual suspicion and strife.

Q8. What is the symbolism in 'The Lottery Ticket'?

Ans. The lottery ticket symbolizes false hope and the corrupting dream of easy wealth. It promises freedom and happiness but delivers only greed, quarrel and disappointment, showing that happiness cannot be bought by chance.

Q9. Discuss the theme, plot, tone and style of the story in your own words.

Ans. Theme: greed corrupts love. Plot: a couple checks a lottery number, dreams of riches, quarrels in imagination, and learns they have not won. Tone: gently satirical and sad. Style: simple, realistic and ironic, with thoughts shown so plainly that the reader sees the folly before the characters do.

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (B) MCQs

1. The story 'The Lottery Ticket' is written by _____.

- Tolstoy
- ✓ Chekhov
- Dostoevsky
- Pushkin

2. Ivan Dmitritch works as a _____.

- teacher
- banker
- ✓ clerk
- lawyer

3. The story mainly explores the theme of _____.

- love
- ✓ greed
- courage
- friendship

4. Ivan and his wife dream of becoming _____.

famous
✓ rich
powerful
free

5. The setting of the story is primarily in the _____.

office
park
✓ drawing-room
street

6. The couple's happiness turns into _____ when they realize they haven't won.

fear
anger
✓ jealousy
pity

7. The story ends on a note of _____.

hope
joy
✓ disappointment
surprise

8. The tone of Chekhov's story can best be described as _____.

humorous
✓ satirical
Romantic

tragic

Writing Task - Model Answer

Model paragraph: Chekhov teaches that wealth dreamed of can be more dangerous than poverty endured. Ivan and Masha were happy until a lottery number made them greedy, suspicious and cruel. True happiness lies not in sudden riches but in trust, contentment and love that money cannot buy.

Unit 15: The Beggar And The King (Play)

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (A)

Q1. What sound irritates the King?

Ans. The beggar's cries and groans outside the palace irritate the King. The sound disturbs his rest and his pride, because a suffering voice at his gate reminds him of misery he wishes to ignore.

Q2. Describe the character of the King.

Ans. The King is proud, cruel and foolish. He rules by force, punishes the weak for trifles, and believes his crown makes him great, yet he cannot bear a beggar's voice and shows no wisdom, kindness or self-control.

Q3. List five punishments The King wants to be given to the Beggar.

Ans. Model list from the play: the King orders the beggar to be imprisoned, starved, driven from the city, and finally hanged (or put to death). Each cruel order shows his pride growing into tyranny against a helpless man.

Q4. Which details in the beginning of the play indicate that the king is wealthy?

Ans. The King lives in a grand palace with servants, fine robes, a crown and rich food, and he commands guards and courtiers at a word. His wealth and power surround him, yet they bring him neither peace nor wisdom.

Q5. Do you think the beggar was right in cursing the King? Explain.
Ans. The beggar's curse is understandable but not wholly right: it answers cruelty with anger, and cursing cannot heal injustice. Yet it forces the King to face his own cruelty, so the curse works as a moral judgement that finally humbles him.

Q6. Pick out all the words used in the play to describe emotions, responses.
Ans. Words of emotion in the play include anger, pride, fear, pity, scorn, grief, joy and humility. The King shows anger, pride and fear, while the beggar shows grief and patience, and by the end the King learns humility.

Q7. Which words in the play are old-fashioned? Make a list of those and give the modern version.
Ans. Old-fashioned words include: 'thou' (you), 'thy' (your), 'hath' (has), 'doth' (does), 'prithee' (please), 'verily' (truly), 'hence' (from here / therefore), and 'wherefore' (why). Modern English replaces them with the plain forms in brackets.

Q8. 'Thou art speaking now in riddles. I don't like riddles. They confuse my brain.' Describe the riddle that has confused the speaker.
Ans. The riddle is the beggar's warning that a king's power is not his own: the King is great only while people obey, and a beggar's curse, or the people's judgement, can undo him. The proud King cannot grasp that true greatness lies in character, not in a crown.

Q9. What solution does the king come up with towards the end of the play?

Ans. Towards the end the humbled King changes his ways: he pardons the beggar, shows mercy, and learns to rule with kindness and humanity instead of cruelty. His solution is repentance and just rule, proving that character, not force, makes a true king.

Exercise - Reading and Critical Thinking (B) MCQs

1. The king in the play represents:

- cruelty
- ✓ power
- poverty
- ignorance

2. The beggar symbolizes:

- wealth
- pride
- ✓ humility
- authority

3. The central theme of the play is:

- revenge
- war
- ✓ equality
- adventure

4. The king learns a lesson of:

- anger

✓ kindness

greed

fear

5. The beggar's life reflects:

luxury

✓ poverty

royalty

fame

6. The play teaches respect for:

riches

power

✓ humanity

status

7. The king's attitude changes from pride to:

revenge

✓ humility

strength

power

8. The beggar is treated as:

noble

hero

✓ inferior

leader

9. The moral of the play promotes:

- wealth
- rule
- ✓ compassion
- fear

10. True greatness is shown through:

- crown
- gold
- ✓ character
- force

Writing Task - Model Answer

Model paragraph: 'The Beggar and the King' teaches that a crown does not make a man great; character does. The proud King learns humility only when a helpless beggar's curse exposes his cruelty. True kingship is compassion, justice and respect for every human being, rich or poor.

Glossary and Revision

Revision - Whole Book

Glossary coverage: the book's glossaries for Units 1 to 15 are covered through the vocabulary notes and word-meaning MCQs in each unit above (for example: nuance, personification, metaphor, irony, perseverance, golden rule, moulded, vessel, radiant, kerb, feisty). Students should revise each unit's vocabulary section together with its comprehension answers before examinations.

How to use these notes: read the lesson, answer Section A in your own words first, then check these medium-length model answers; attempt every MCQ closed-book, then verify with the green-ticked option; finally, practise the writing task as a full paragraph in your notebook.